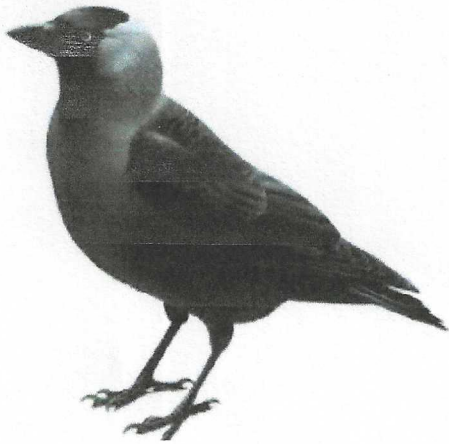


Birds

The Jackdaw – *Corvus Monedula*



Smallest of the corvid family, easily recognisable with its grey nape and pale eye, and its upright brisk strutting.

- ❖ The call we hear most is a cutting and metallic kya or chak
 - ❖ The females' call can be more drawn out when begging for food!
 - ❖ Nestlings at 25 days, having by that time developed a penetrating shriek, suddenly go silent if they hear an unfamiliar noise

A skilful flyer and a *clattering* of jackdaws can display acrobatic flight manoeuvres as they gather for roosting.



A pair of Jackdaws maintains a lifelong bond.

They get on well with people too. Especially if they provide some snacks!

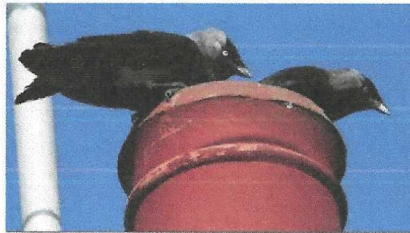
Birds



And builds its simple nest of twigs
in cavities in trees and buildings.

Well-known for building in church towers and
down chimneys.

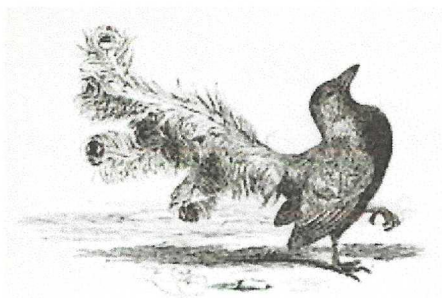
Hopefully ours are too small.



Eats seeds and scraps, young birds and eggs, and fruit – a whole treeful of russet
apples according to a Guardian letter writer! Gets

- ❖ In Ancient Greek folklore, a jackdaw can be caught with a dish of oil. Such a narcissistic creature, it falls in while looking at its own reflection.
- The jackdaw was considered sacred in Welsh folklore as it nested in church steeples – the devil shunned it because of its choice of residence.
 - Nineteenth century belief in the Fens held that seeing a jackdaw on the way to a wedding was a good omen for a bride.

And the best picture of all



Harrison Weir's 1881 illustration of a vain jackdaw
wearing peacock feathers

for "*The Bird in Borrowed Feathers*"

also known as "*The Vain Jackdaw*" Aesop's Fable

Risinghurst and Sandhills Parish Council May 2019

www.risinghurstsandhillsparishcouncil.com